

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Trump said he plans** to roll back federal fuel-economy rules for passenger vehicles, his latest move to relieve the U.S. auto industry from mandates to build cleaner, more-fuel-efficient cars. **A1**
- ◆ **Vanguard plans** to start letting workers buy an annuity within a 401(k) target-date fund that it will make available to employers in 2026. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** advanced, with the S&P 500, Dow industrials and Nasdaq gaining 0.3%, 0.9% and 0.2%, respectively. **B8**
- ◆ **OpenAI CEO Sam Altman** has explored putting together funds to acquire or partner with a rocket company, which would allow him to compete against Musk's SpaceX. **B1**
- ◆ **An industry group** said it aims to organize Amazon's delivery-service providers to fight for better terms and reverse policies they say wipe out their profits. **B1**
- ◆ **More than 57 million** people watched the Dallas Cowboys beat the Kansas City Chiefs on CBS on Thanksgiving, setting a viewing record for a regular-season NFL game. **B1**
- ◆ **HSBC named** Brendan Nelson as chairman following a yearlong search to fill one of the biggest jobs in global finance. **B1**
- ◆ **The FTC directed Boeing** to divest itself of Spirit AeroSystems assets to resolve antitrust concerns about its proposed acquisition of the parts maker. **B2**
- ◆ **Macy's raised its** full-year outlook and reported its highest comparable sales growth in 13 quarters as its turnaround plan begins to deliver results. **B1**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Two survivors** of a Sept. 2 U.S. strike on a drug boat in the Caribbean were killed in follow-on attacks after they were seen still aboard the damaged vessel alongside packages of illegal narcotics, a senior commander was expected to tell lawmakers. **A1**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth** asked Adm. Alvin Holsey, then the head of U.S. military operations in the Caribbean, to step down before announcing the officer's retirement in mid-October. **A8**
- ◆ **A Pentagon watchdog** found that Hegseth violated some department regulations when he shared sensitive information from his cellphone on Signal earlier this year. **A9**
- ◆ **Federal agents arrived** in New Orleans, the latest focus of the Trump administration's strengthened immigration enforcement. **A3**
- ◆ **The EU scaled back** a plan to use Russia's frozen assets to make a loan to Ukraine, leaving a window open for a U.S. push to use the money to lure Russia into a peace deal. **A6**
- ◆ **The bloc reached a deal** to permanently halt imports of Russian gas, a milestone in the EU's efforts to sever energy ties with Moscow. **A6**
- ◆ **Former FDA commissioners** said new vaccine standards threaten to put Americans' health at risk and upend the agency's scientific integrity. **A3**
- ◆ **Republican Rep. Elise Stefanik**, a prominent Trump ally, criticized House Speaker Mike Johnson, calling him an ineffective leader who is losing control of the GOP conference heading into the midterm elections. **A4**

CONTENTS	Market Data..... B6
Arts in Review..... A13	Opinion..... A15-17
Business & Finance..... B2	Personal Journal A11-12
Business News..... B3	Sports..... A14
Crossword..... A14	Technology..... B4
Heard on Street..... B9	U.S. News..... A2-4
Markets..... B8	World News..... A6-10



Drums of War Feel Distant in Strapped Caracas



GETTING BY: People in Venezuela's capital of Caracas are maintaining a sense of normalcy even amid punishing inflation and U.S. threats against leader Nicolás Maduro. American pressure is 'just talk and talk and talk,' said one holiday shopper. **A8**

Admiral to Contend Survivors Of Boat Strike Were Fair Target

Commander to tell Congress that damaged craft tried to continue drug run

By **SHELBY HOLLIDAY** AND **ALEXANDER WARD**

WASHINGTON—Two survivors of a Sept. 2 U.S. strike on a boat in the Caribbean were killed in follow-up attacks after they were seen still aboard the damaged vessel alongside packages of illegal narcotics, a senior commander is expected to tell lawmakers Thursday.

Adm. Frank "Mitch" Bradley plans to say he and his legal adviser concluded the two survivors were attempting to continue their drug run, making them and the already-damaged vessel legitimate targets for another attack, two defense officials said. The details of the strike have emerged as a key matter of concern for members of Congress who are seeking more information about the role played by Bradley and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and whether aspects of the operation violated laws of war or Pentagon procedures.

The version of events Bradley is expected to deliver would rebut claims by legal experts that the killing of the two survivors could have constituted a war crime. Lawmakers are likely to press Bradley, who commanded Joint Special Operations Command at the time, in the closed-door briefing on the extent of the damage to the boat, whether the men were injured, how Bradley reached his conclusions that the survivors were still legitimate targets, and whether he considered rescuing them. The attack was the first use

of military force against drug boats by the administration and the only one in which survivors are known to have been targeted and killed in follow-up strikes. In mid-October, the Coast Guard rescued two survivors of an attack on a submersible because they were deemed unable to fight, according to the defense officials. The administration has launched 21 strikes in all, kill-
Please turn to page A8

- ◆ **Hegseth pushed out admiral** after boat strike clash..... **A8**
- ◆ **Pentagon review finds** Signalgate violated rules... **A9**

Mexican Drug Lords Choose: Snitch or Suffer

More than 55 cartel leaders were turned over to the U.S. by their home country in cloak-and-dagger missions

By **STEVE FISHER** AND **SANTIAGO PÉREZ**

MEXICO CITY—Dozens of Mexico's most dangerous prisoners, cuffed hand and foot, boarded army jets under heavy guard this year, a rogues' gallery of cartel leaders responsible for smuggling tons of heroin, fentanyl, cocaine and methamphetamine to insatiable U.S. buyers. The men were rousted from prisons, where money and corruption provided them with weapons, cocaine, booze, women and phones to run their lucrative underworld empires from behind bars, coordinating drug shipments as well as ordering killings

and kidnappings, U.S. and Mexican officials said. The prisoners had no idea of their destination. "Welcome to America!" said Derek Maltz, interim head of the Drug Enforcement Administration when he greeted the first batch of prisoners as they disembarked nine months ago. A second group arrived in August, a total of 55 men who face charges that could keep them locked in maximum-security prisons for the rest of their lives. The prisoners represent the top echelons of Mexico's biggest criminal organizations—
Please turn to page A10

Waymos Are Done Being Nice

Self-driving cars learn to bend rules of the road

By **KATHERINE BINDLEY**

SAN FRANCISCO—It was like a scene out of a movie: a pair of white Jaguars zipping through a two-lane tunnel, changing lanes at the same time in a zigzag formation. But this one had a twist. They were both Waymos, the self-driving vehicles known for their achingly cautious behavior. "I had never seen anyone switch lanes in that tunnel," says Sophia Yen, a startup founder who was in her car behind the two autonomous ones in September. "It's driving more like a taxi driver—an aggressive, New York taxi"
Please turn to page A12

Vanguard Joins Push For 401(k) Annuities

By **ANNE TERGESEN**

Vanguard Group plans to start letting workers buy an annuity within a new 401(k) target-date fund. The nation's largest target-date fund provider will make the fund available to employers starting sometime in 2026. Like any target-date fund, it will combine stocks and bonds, shifting to a more-conservative mix as investors age. But it will also give older workers the option of moving some of their 401(k) savings into an annuity, an insurance contract that converts an upfront lump-sum payment into fixed monthly payments for life. A 65-year-old worker nearing retirement with a \$1 million portfolio might use 25% to pay for an annuity, which today could provide about \$1,670 a month. The worker would also be able to withdraw from the rest of the 401(k) savings,

which would remain in stocks and bonds. The move by Vanguard, which manages about 40% of the \$4.5 trillion in target-date funds, suggests that annuities embedded in diversified 401(k) investments are slowly moving into the mainstream. Target-date funds are typically the default investments when employers automatically enroll workers in 401(k) plans. Until recently, employers have largely focused on helping workers accumulate larger 401(k) balances. But as baby boomers retire, they are adding products and services that aim to replicate pensions, which cover a dwindling share of the U.S. workforce. As 401(k)s have surpassed pensions, "There is far less guaranteed income in retirement," said Lauren Valente, head of workplace solutions at Vanguard. Annuities provide a
Please turn to page A4

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
AI chatbots can help make gift shopping for the holidays a lot easier. **A11**



SPORTS
Three-time NBA MVP Nikola Jokic is having the best season of his career. **A14**

salesforce

What if your company could solve problems before you even knew they existed?

It can with Agentforce.

Find out how at agentforce.com.